

ECON 131: PUBLIC ECONOMICS

Spring 2026

GSI:	Steve Ramos	DIS 107	R 8AM-9AM - 2 Evans
Email:	steve.ramos@berkeley.edu	DIS 105	R 11AM-12PM - 2 Evans
		DIS 104	R 1PM-2PM - 2 Evans

Office Hours: Thursday from 9:00AM until 11:00AM in 640 Evans. If you cannot make this time, feel free to attend any of the other GSI's office hours (OH's). All OH's are posted on the bCourses page and the course syllabus. I also highly encourage you to attend Professor Yagan's office hours at least once this semester. OH's are a great way to get to know faculty, learn about their research, and about other opportunities on and off campus.

Objectives: This course focuses on the role of the government in the economy from a positive and a normative perspective. During section I will provide you with handouts, where we will review difficult concepts and tools as we go over some exercises. This will be good practice to master the material and prepare for the exams. Typed solutions, in addition to my written solutions, to section problems will be posted on our bCourses section website within two weeks. Given the technical nature of this course, students should be comfortable with multivariate calculus.

Email Policy: Sections and office hours are the best place to ask questions about course material. If you send a question via email, be as specific and concise as possible. I will do my best to respond to emails within 48 hours. Additionally, please make sure to include "[Econ 131]" in the subject line of all emails, otherwise emails might get lost in my inbox.

Attendance Policy: Attendance is **not** mandatory but highly encouraged. Sections will meet in person and will not be recorded.

Enrollment Issues: If you have any problems with enrollment, please contact the Head GSI (head-gsi@econ.berkeley.edu). I have no authority over these matters.

Covid-19 Policy: While masks are *not* required you are encouraged to wear a mask while indoors or when you are in close proximity to others. Please **do not** come to class if you are feeling sick.

Community Guidelines:

- Be Respectful
- Collaborate, Don't Compete
- Take space, make space
- Be inclusive

Student Honor Code and Academic Integrity: *As a member of the UC Berkeley community, I act with honesty, integrity, and respect for others.* As your graduate student instructor, I am committed to creating a learning environment that is welcoming, equitable, accessible and respectful. However, this can only be achieved if we all live up to this responsibility. Please do your part by acting with integrity and treating others with respect.

Limits to Confidentiality: As UC employees, all course instructors and tutors are Responsible Employees and are therefore required to report incidents of sexual violence, sexual harassment or other conduct prohibited by university policy to the Title IX officer. We cannot keep reports of sexual harassment or

sexual violence confidential, but the Title IX officer will consider requests for confidentiality. There are confidential resources available to you, including the PATH to Care Center, which serves survivors of sexual violence and sexual harassment.

Disability-Related Accommodations If you are registered with the Disabled Students' Program (DSP) and need disability-related accommodations, please let me and the course instructor know as soon as possible so we can make appropriate arrangements. If you need accommodations but are not registered with DSP, please contact DSP by phone at (510) 642-0518 (voice), (510) 642-6376 (TTY), or e-mail dsp@berkeley.edu. For more information, please visit the DSP [website](#).